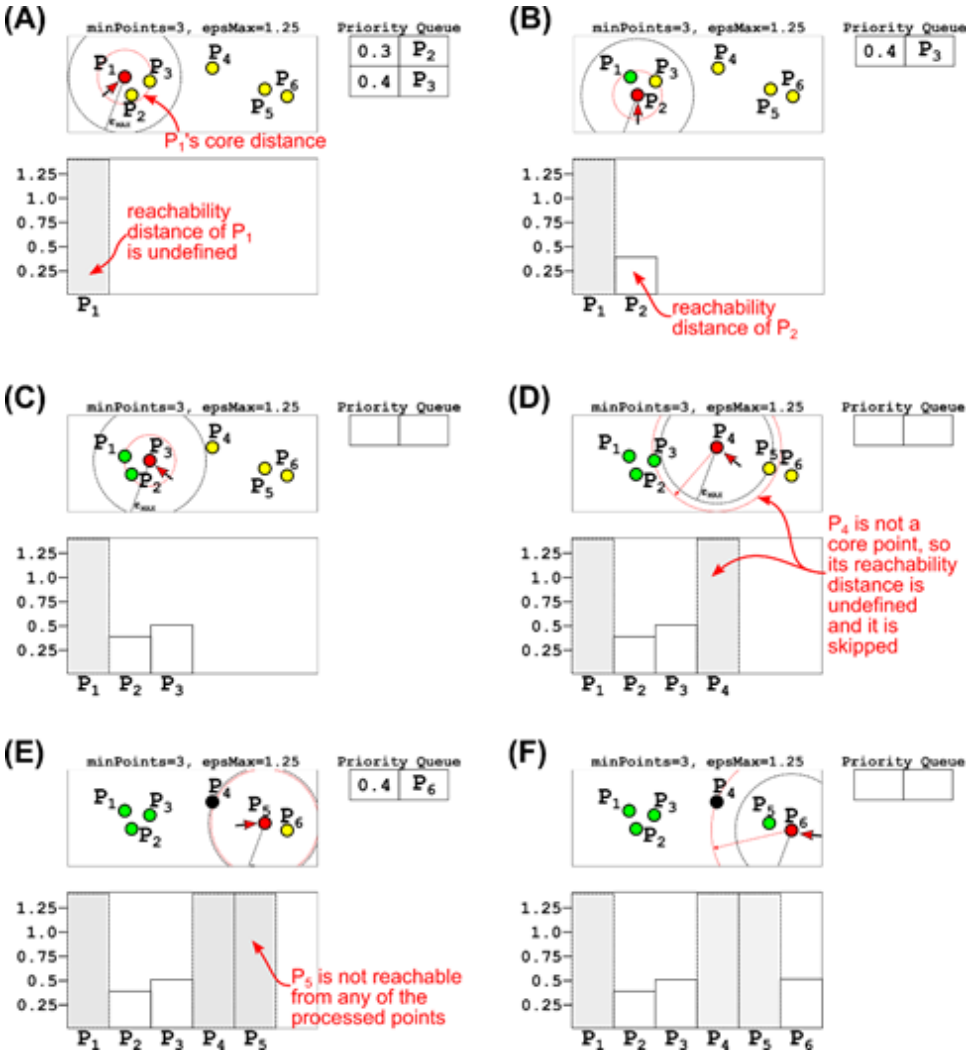


Figure 12.16 An example of how OPTICS constructs the ordering and list of reachability distances. Notice that the choice of the first point is completely arbitrary, it can be even be random: here we chose to start from P_1 just for convenience, to present a cleaner example. Likewise, at step (E) we could have chosen P_6 instead of P_5: if that happened, we wouldn't have been able to compute its reachability distance from P_5 (or vice versa). Choosing a larger value for ε_{MAX} would help avoiding these situations.